

SCAFFOLDED WORKBOOK

SWIM & WATER SAFETY

Health & Physical Education | Year 7-8 | Simplified Edition

This workbook has word banks, sentence starters,
and circle choices to help you.
Short, clear answers are great!

STUDENT NAME

CLASS

TEACHER

Welcome to your Simplified Water Safety Workbook.

This workbook has word banks, sentence starters, and circle choices to help you. You do not need to write long answers — short, clear answers are great!

1 Why Water Safety Matters in Victoria

Key Facts — Remember These!

- **54 people** drowned in Victoria in 2023–24.
- **1 in 5** victims were aged 15–24 — the same age as you in a few years.
- **ZERO deaths** happened at patrolled beaches or pools. Every death happened without a lifeguard.
- **Males** are 4 times more likely to drown than females.
- **Rivers, dams and lakes** cause most drowning deaths — not the beach.

Source: Life Saving Victoria Drowning Report 2023-24 — lsv.com.au/research/victorian-drowning-reports/

Activity 1.1 — About Me and Water

~5 min

Circle your answers:

My favourite water place is (circle):	How good a swimmer am I? (circle):
The beach / A river or lake / A public pool / A backyard pool / I don't like swimming	Still learning / Can swim a little / Good swimmer / Very strong swimmer

Activity 1.2 — Looking at the Data

~10 min

Answer these questions. Use the word bank to help you.

Word Bank:

patrolled | unpatrolled | lifeguard | 54 | rivers | dangerous | 15-24 | males

Question 1 [1 mark]

How many people drowned in Victoria in 2023-24?

The answer is: _____

Question 2 [1 mark]

Where did ALL of the drowning deaths happen? Circle: At patrolled beaches / At unpatrolled locations / At public pools / At school

Question 3 [2 marks]

Finish these sentences using words from the word bank:

Most drowning deaths happen at _____ locations because there is no _____ watching.

Question 4 [2 marks]

Write TWO reasons why young people might be at higher risk near water. Use the idea bank: peer pressure | showing off | risky dares | overconfident | no lifeguard

Idea 1: Young people might drown because _____

2 Beach Flags and Rip Currents

Key Facts — Beach Flags

- **Red and Yellow flags** = ALWAYS swim here. A lifeguard is watching you.
- **Single red flag** = Dangerous. Only very experienced swimmers should enter.
- **Black and white squares** = For surfboards only. Swimmers must stay out.
- **Yellow with black ball** = Swimmers only. No surfboards.
- **Orange windsock** = Offshore winds. NO inflatable toys — they will blow out to sea.
- **Purple flag** = Dangerous sea creatures. Be careful.

Activity 2.1 — Name the Flags [Colour required on this page]

~8 min

Look at each flag. Write its name using the word bank.

Flag Name Bank:

Red & Yellow | Single Red | Black & White | Yellow + Black Ball | Orange Windsock | Purple

Flag	Name (from word bank)	Can swimmers use it? (Yes / No)
Red top half / Yellow bottom half (red & yellow)		Yes — always swim here
All red		
Black & white checkerboard		
Yellow with black circle		
Orange cone/windsock		No inflatables allowed
Purple		

Activity 2.2 — Rip Currents [Colour required on this page]

~10 min

A **rip current** is fast-moving water that pulls you away from the beach. Look at the diagram in your colour workbook, then answer:

Word Bank for Rip Steps:

Stay calm | Float | Swim sideways | Swim back | Raise one arm

Question 2.2a [2 marks]

If caught in a rip, you should swim: (circle one) A) Directly back to shore (fight the current) B) Sideways along the shore (parallel) C) Straight out to sea

Question 2.2b [2 marks]

Write the 5 rip escape steps using the word bank:

Step 1: _____

Question 2.2c [2 marks]

STORY: Liam went to a beach with no flags. He felt water pulling him away. He panicked and tried to swim back. He got very tired. What were TWO mistakes Liam made? Circle: (A) He swam at an unpatrolled beach (B) He wore a hat (C) He tried to swim against the rip (D) He had a friend with him What should he have done? He should have...

He should have: _____

3 Emergency Response — DRS ABCD

DRS ABCD — What to Do in an Emergency

- **D = Danger** — Check for danger FIRST. Is it safe for YOU to go near?
- **R = Response** — Tap their shoulder and call their name loudly.
- **S = Send for help** — Call **000** (or tell someone else to call).
- **A = Airway** — Tilt their head back gently to open their airway.
- **B = Breathing** — Look, listen and feel — are they breathing?
- **C = CPR** — 30 chest pushes, then 2 breaths. Keep going until help arrives.
- **D = Defibrillation** — Use the AED machine if one is nearby. It tells you what to do.

Source: St John Ambulance Victoria — stjohnvic.com.au/first-aid-resources/

THROW, DON'T GO — The Most Important Rule!

If someone is drowning, DO NOT jump in unless you are trained. You might drown too! Throw them a rope, towel, pool noodle, or anything that floats. Call 000 first.

Activity 3.1 — DRS ABCD Practice

~5 min

Fill in the missing word for each letter. Use the word bank.

Word Bank:

Danger | Response | Send (000) | Airway | Breathing | CPR | Defibrillation

Letter	Word	What you do
D	DANGER	Check it is safe before going near
R		Tap shoulder and call their name
S		Call 000 immediately
A		Tilt head back to open airway
B		Look/listen/feel — are they breathing?
C		30 chest pushes + 2 breaths
D		Use the AED machine if available

Activity 3.2 — What Do You Do?

Pairs · ~8 min

Story:

You are at a pool party. You look over and see someone floating face-down in the water. They are not moving. You have your phone. There is a rope near the pool edge.

Question 3.2a [1 mark]

What is the VERY FIRST thing you do? Circle: A) Jump in to help B) Check for danger first C) Run away D) Start CPR immediately

Question 3.2b [1 mark]

What number do you call?

I call: _____

Question 3.2c [2 marks]

Write what you would say. Use this starter: "Hello, I need an ambulance. I am at _____. Someone has _____. They are / are not (circle) breathing."

4 Making Safe Decisions Near Water

The 5 LSV SwimSafe Rules

- **Read signs** — Always check flags and warnings before going in.
- **Enter feet first** — Never dive into water you don't know.
- **Stay in depth** — Only swim where your feet can touch the bottom.
- **Swim with a friend** — NEVER swim alone.
- **Signal for help** — Raise ONE arm if you need help.

Activity 4.0 — Spot the Hazards

Pairs · ~10 min

For each water place, write TWO dangers from the hazard bank: rip current | no lifeguard | cold water | hidden rocks | strong river current | diving into shallow water | no fencing | submerged logs

Water Place	Danger 1	Danger 2
Unpatrolled beach		
River or dam		
Backyard pool		

Question 4.0a [1 mark]

Which place is MOST dangerous? Circle: Unpatrolled beach / River or dam / Backyard pool I chose this because: _____

Activity 4.1 — Safe or Not Safe?

~8 min

Situation	SAFE or NOT SAFE? (circle)	Better choice:
Swimming at a beach with red and yellow flags	SAFE / NOT SAFE	Already safe!
Swimming at a river after heavy rain	SAFE / NOT SAFE	
Using an inflatable lilo when orange windsock is up	SAFE / NOT SAFE	
Going for a swim by yourself in a dam	SAFE / NOT SAFE	

Question 4.1a [2 marks]

Your friend says "Let's jump in this river — it looks fine!" What could you say? Use this starter: "I don't think that's safe because _____. Let's go to _____ instead."

5 Rivers, Dams and Cold Water

Cold Water Facts

- Victorian lakes and rivers can be very cold — sometimes as cold as 12 degrees even in summer!
- Cold water makes your body gasp — you might accidentally breathe in water.
- Cold water quickly makes your muscles stop working — even strong swimmers can get into trouble.
- The safe way to enter cold water: go in slowly, one step at a time. Never jump straight in.

Activity 5.1 — Cold Water and Throw Rescue

~12 min

Question 5.1a [2 marks]

What are TWO things cold water does to your body? Circle TWO: (A) Makes you gasp (B) Makes you swim faster (C) Makes your muscles stop working (D) Makes you more alert

Question 5.1b [1 mark]

What is the SAFEST way to enter cold water? Circle: Jump straight in / Go in slowly, step by step / Run and dive in headfirst

Throw Rescue — rank from BEST (1) to WORST (5): Remember: THROW, DON'T GO — never jump in!

Tool	My rank (1=best)
Rope with a floating end	
Life ring attached to the jetty	
Jumping in to help them swim	
Throwing a pool noodle	
Holding out a towel from the edge	

Activity 5.2 — Diving and Spinal Injury: What You Need to Know

~10 min

Important Facts About Diving:

- Unsafe diving causes 10% of all spinal cord injuries in Australia (AIHW).
- The most common victims are males aged 10-14 — that could be someone you know.
- Two-thirds of people injured this way are permanently disabled — often unable to move their arms or legs.
- A sandbank can form overnight — a place that was safe last week might not be safe today.

The rule: Feet First, First Time, Every Time — always go in feet-first before diving anywhere.

Three Real Stories — What Happened and Why:

Story	What happened	Key lesson
Terrigal Wharf NSW 2025	A teenage boy dived from a wharf and hit shallow water below. Helicopter evacuation to hospital.	Wharves can sit over surprisingly shallow water. Height above the water tells you nothing about depth.
Torquay Beach VIC 2025	A teenage boy dived at a surf beach and seriously injured his spine. A sandbank had shifted.	Surf beach sandbanks shift with every tide. Depth at any spot changes constantly.
Bawley Beach NSW 2024	A young man dived from a jetty he had safely used before. A sandbank had formed since his last visit.	"I've done it here before" is not a safety check. Always check depth every single time.

Question 5.2a [1 mark]

The safest way to enter unknown water is to: (A) Dive in head-first (B) Go in feet-first every single time (C) Ask someone if it looks deep (D) Jump from as high as possible. Circle your answer.

Question 5.2b [2 marks]

In the Bawley Beach story, the young man had jumped from the same jetty safely before. Why was it still dangerous this time? Explain in your own words.

Question 5.2c [2 marks]

Your friend says: "That river is fine to dive into — we've done it heaps of times." What would you say to keep them safe?

6 My Water Safety Plan

Activity 6.1 — My Safety Rules

~10 min

Write the 5 SwimSafe rules. Use the bank: Read signs | Enter feet first | Stay in depth | Swim with a friend | Signal for help

Rule 1: _____

Question 6.1a [1 mark]

Which rule is MOST important for you? Circle one: Read signs / Enter feet first / Stay in depth / Swim with a friend / Signal for help I chose this rule because: _____

Activity 6.2 — My Campaign (Assessment Task)

~20 min · Assessment

Create a water safety message. Choose ONE:

Option	What to do
A - Social Media Post	Design an Instagram post. Draw it or write what the picture and words would say.
B - Letter to Year 5	Write a short letter to a Year 5 student about ONE water safety rule they should know.

I chose Option: _____*My key message is:* _____*One water safety fact I will use:* _____*Where I found the fact (website):* _____**How Did I Go? Circle: Not yet / Getting there / Got it!**

Skill / Knowledge	Not yet	Getting there	Got it!	
I know what the red and yellow flags mean	■	■	■	
I know how to escape a rip current	■	■	■	
I know the DRS ABCD steps	■	■	■	
I know all 5 SwimSafe rules	■	■	■	
I know why rivers and dams are dangerous	■	■	■	